

July 24th, 2026
Week 30
Volume 282, Issue 1245

QUOTE
of the
WEEK

"It ain't over till it's over."

- Yogi Berra

Highlights:

- Crude tops \$100.
- Second front opens.
- Freight rolls over.
- Waters recede.

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-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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CRUDE CROSSES, WATERS RECEDE

The thirteenth consecutive night of American strikes closed out the week, and for the first time since this conflict began, the map grew. Yemen's Houthis struck two Saudi oil tankers in the Red Sea and threatened a blockade of the Bab al-Mandab Strait, the route Saudi barrels had been taking around a shut Hormuz. Washington answered with threats of military punishment for further attacks on shipping and floated billing the damage to frozen Iranian assets, while both sides ruled out near-term talks. Asked about a ceasefire, President Trump said Iran needs "more of the same." The war that spent months confined to one strait has developed ambitions.

Oil did what oil does when chokepoints multiply. Brent crossed USD 100 on Thursday for the first time since May before easing to USD 97.63 by Friday, with WTI near USD 89.77, still leaving crude up roughly ten percent on the week. A third front opened quietly in the Black Sea, where drone attacks on tankers loading at the Caspian Pipeline Consortium terminal on July 17, 19, and 21 halted operations, forcing Kazakhstan, which routes some four-fifths of its exports through the terminal, to cut production. Asian buyers have begun pricing Saudi crude via the Suez Canal and around the Cape of Good Hope, itineraries last considered state-of-the-art in 1869 and during the *Ever Given's* brief tenancy, respectively.

Freight, which spent last week ignoring the war, spent this week ignoring its own rally. The Baltic Dry Index fell more than six percent last week to 2,752 and kept going, touching 2,671 on Monday, its lowest since July 2, as the Capesize index dropped 5.6% and then another 5.1% to 3,889 on softer iron ore and coal enquiry and improving vessel availability. The Supramax index, contrary as ever, climbed to 1,738, its highest since August 2022. Last week's edition noted that cargo fundamentals were winning the argument "for another week." The market, rarely so punctual, took the deadline literally. Softer Capesize earnings are the first genuine nudge toward the beach in months; the problem now is not the intent to exit, but the routes out.

The data calendar offered no fresh inflation prints. June's readings, from Washington's 3.5% to Karachi's 11.1%, remain operative until August, each now arguing in advance with an oil price that spent Thursday above USD 100. The TCMB filled the vacuum by holding at 37% for a fourth consecutive meeting. Currencies did the talking instead: USD/INR touched 96.88 on Thursday, near May's 96.97 record, before recovering toward 96.50; the Taka held at 123.35; the Lira set fresh records near 47.35; and the Pakistani Rupee closed near 278.40, again inside a quarter-rupee range. At this point, it is less an exchange rate than a physical constant.

In Bangladesh, the human toll from this month's flooding has risen to 57 confirmed dead, most in Cox's Bazar, including thirteen Rohingya refugees, with more than a million people affected at the peak. The waters are receding: shelters have consolidated to 111, relief allocations continue to move, and forecasters are watching river basins rather than the sky. Recovery, not rescue, is finally the operative word.

Commercially, Chattogram is stirring. Port operations have largely normalised, and a threatened 48-hour container transport strike was announced and withdrawn within the same week, resolved, unlike the weather, by conversation. The week's sharpest lesson came from compliance: a tanker was sanctioned after arrival and after clearances were complete, caught between anchorage and beach, while appetite across the basin tilted firmly toward bulkers and clean-history units.

The war has opened a second front at sea just as the weather has closed its front on land, and the beach is drying out in time to receive whatever gets through. The market remains paused, not broken. The ships wait for passage. The yards, at last, wait only for the tide.

BANGLADESH



WATERS RECEDE, WINDOW WAITS

The toll.

The confirmed death toll from this month's floods and landslides has reached 57, according to the Ministry of Disaster Management and Relief, with three deaths added in the most recent daily reporting period. Cox's Bazar accounts for 32 of the dead, including thirteen Rohingya refugees killed in camp landslides; Chattogram has recorded fifteen, Bandarban six, Rangamati three, and Moulvibazar one. More than a million people across seven districts were affected at the peak. The waters are now receding: 111 shelters remain open with roughly 4,000 people still in them, down from tens of thousands, and allocations of emergency cash and rice continue to reach the worst-affected areas. Forecasters are still monitoring the river basins, but the operative word this week, for the first time this month, is recovery.

Recovery begins.

The commercial thaw is visible. Chattogram port operations have largely normalised, with average vessel waiting back near a day and a half, and a threatened 48-hour prime mover and flatbed strike over an increased advance income tax was announced and then withdrawn inside the same week following talks, a dispute that resolved faster than the floodwater. Local steel trading, dormant through the deluge, has begun to pick up as yards reopen, and mills expect firmer demand once the monsoon passes. Beaching eyes now turn to the July 29 to August 1 tide window, the first with meaningful capacity since the rains began, with a second window to follow August 12 to 15. The deferred supply has not disappeared; the beach may finally be ready to receive it.

Compliance bites.

The week's sharpest development was regulatory rather than meteorological. A tanker was sanctioned after its arrival at Chattogram and after clearances were completed, caught, in effect, between the anchorage and the beach, and the episode has sharpened caution across recyclers and cash buyers alike. Enquiry for tonnage remains healthy but increasingly selective, favouring bulkers and units free of compliance exposure. USD/BDT held near 123.35 at the top of its established band, and with no inflation print due until early August, June's 9.16% remains the operative read. The plot floor is drying out. The paperwork, it turns out, can flood too.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA



TIGHT PLATES, FRESH RECORDS

USD/INR touched 96.88 on Thursday, its closest approach yet to the May 21 record of approximately 96.97, before a Friday recovery returned it toward 96.50. The Reserve Bank remained visible, smoothing the move through state-run banks, while equity and bond markets absorbed the year's third escalation with notably less drama than the first two, a market that has, like everyone else, learned the script. With no CPI print due until mid-August, June's 4.38% surprise stands as the operative number, and July's reading is being struck against an oil price that visited three digits.

Rupee at the door.

Local steel plate at Alang firmed through the week from approximately INR 38,200 toward INR 38,500, with the USD equivalent approaching USD 400 as monsoon-slowed cutting activity tightened plate supply faster than the weakening Rupee could offset it. The move is real but fragile: downstream steel demand remains tepid, several vessels remain away from shore, and the rebound owes more to scarcity than appetite. The July 11 to 20 tide window closed with little fanfare; the next opens Monday, July 27, and runs through August 4.

Plates firm.

Alang's structural position strengthened almost by accident this week. As compliance caution sweeps Chattogram following the sanctioned tanker episode, India's status as the basin's only market accepting dark fleet tonnage has quietly turned from footnote into commercial moat. The wider position is otherwise unchanged for a fourth consecutive week: the deepest capacity, more than 115 valid Statements of Compliance, the strongest compliance profile, the weakest price, and now, uniquely, the widest door.

The niche widens.

PAKISTAN



SCARCE SHIPS, STEADY HANDS

*Two fronts,
same lanes.*

The Red Sea attacks and the continuing closure of Hormuz have placed Gadani's routing lanes between two contested waterways for the first time in this conflict. Brokers report war-risk premiums firming again for Gulf-transiting recycling candidates, and the locational calculus that briefly favoured Pakistan in the spring has been reshuffled once more, this time with fewer safe approaches rather than more. Oil's week above USD 100, meanwhile, is the development Islamabad least wanted: the import bill does not care whose blockade it is.

Rupee, immovable.

USD/PKR closed near 278.40, once again inside a quarter-rupee weekly range, through a thirteenth night of strikes, a tanker war on a second sea, and crude at triple digits. For the fourth escalation-grade week this year, the Pakistani Rupee has simply declined to participate. The State Bank's 11.5% policy rate and disciplined reserve management continue to take the credit, and June's 11.1% CPI, with its rare outright monthly decline, remains the operative reading until early August. Stability this durable stopped being a policy outcome some weeks ago; it is now simply a personality.

*Supply short,
hopes fiscal.*

Gadani's fundamentals held: candidates remain scarce, purchasing appetite stays firm, and an enduring scrap shortage continues to underpin demand. Recyclers' offers were unmoved even as local plate prices held near PKR 196,000 for most of the week before firming to PKR 200,000 on Friday, equivalent to approximately USD 714 per tonne. Actual consumption has yet to follow that sentiment, but optimism rests on fiscal measures: a lower property withholding tax and subsidised housing schemes are expected to lift construction demand once the monsoon clears. Pakistan can currently compete with India on price. Bangladesh remains, for now, out of reach.

TURKEY

FOURTH HOLD, SAME SONG



The TCMB kept its policy rate at 37% on Thursday, the fourth consecutive hold, noting that underlying inflation eased slightly in June while leading indicators point to a July rebound, struck, as everywhere else, against renewed conflict and a resurgent oil price. The committee's language is unchanged: restrictive until price stability is achieved. USD/TRY marked fresh record territory near 47.35 regardless, with the central bank still selling into the market to keep depreciation orderly and the effective overnight rate near 40% doing the heavy lifting.

Held, again.

June's official 32.11%, the lowest since March, remains the headline figure; the Inflation Research Group's independent estimate of 51.4% remains the argument. Both are now stale. The July print lands in early August, and both face the same headwind: June's reading benefited from a ceasefire-era oil price that no longer exists. A repeat of that favour is not on offer.

The other number.

Aliaga's plate indications held at USD 263 to 285 per LDT across vessel types, structurally uncompetitive against the sub-continent for a fourth consecutive week, with a weak Lira eroding purchasing power and a thin pool of candidates dampening sentiment. Turkey's share continues to be defined by EU regulation, Basel Convention compliance, and specialist tonnage rather than price. Four holds, four weeks, one niche: the song does not change, and neither, apparently, does anything else.

Niche, unmoved.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 30 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / Vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	Softening	445-450 / LDT	465-470 / LDT	475-480 / LDT
2	Pakistan	Steady	443-448 / LDT	463-468 / LDT	473-478 / LDT
3	India	Steady	420-425 / LDT	440-445 / LDT	450-455 / LDT
4	Turkey	Softening	262-264 / LDT	272-274 / LDT	282-284 / LDT

DID YOU KNOW?

- **69.16 million tonnes of steel** recovered through ship recycling at Alang is enough to manufacture approximately **69 million passenger vehicles**.
- **72.55 million MT of CO₂ emissions avoided** through ship recycling at Alang is equivalent to the annual carbon sequestration of approximately **72.6 million acres of forest**.
- **276 million cubic yards of landfill space saved** through ship recycling at Alang is equivalent to approximately **84,000 Olympic-size swimming pools**.

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	DELIVERY TIDES
August 15 – Independence Day	July 27 – August 04

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	DELIVERY TIDES
August 05 - July Uprising Day August 26 - Eid-e-Milad-un-Nabi	July 29 – August 01 August 12 – August 15

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	TURKEY
August 14 – Independence Day August 25 – Eid Milad-un-Nabi	August 30 – Victory Day

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ALANG - Port Position as of July 24, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Stolt Kikyo	3,305	Chemical Tanker	Arrived July 19
2	Gautam	780	Supply	Delivered July 18

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of July 24, 2026

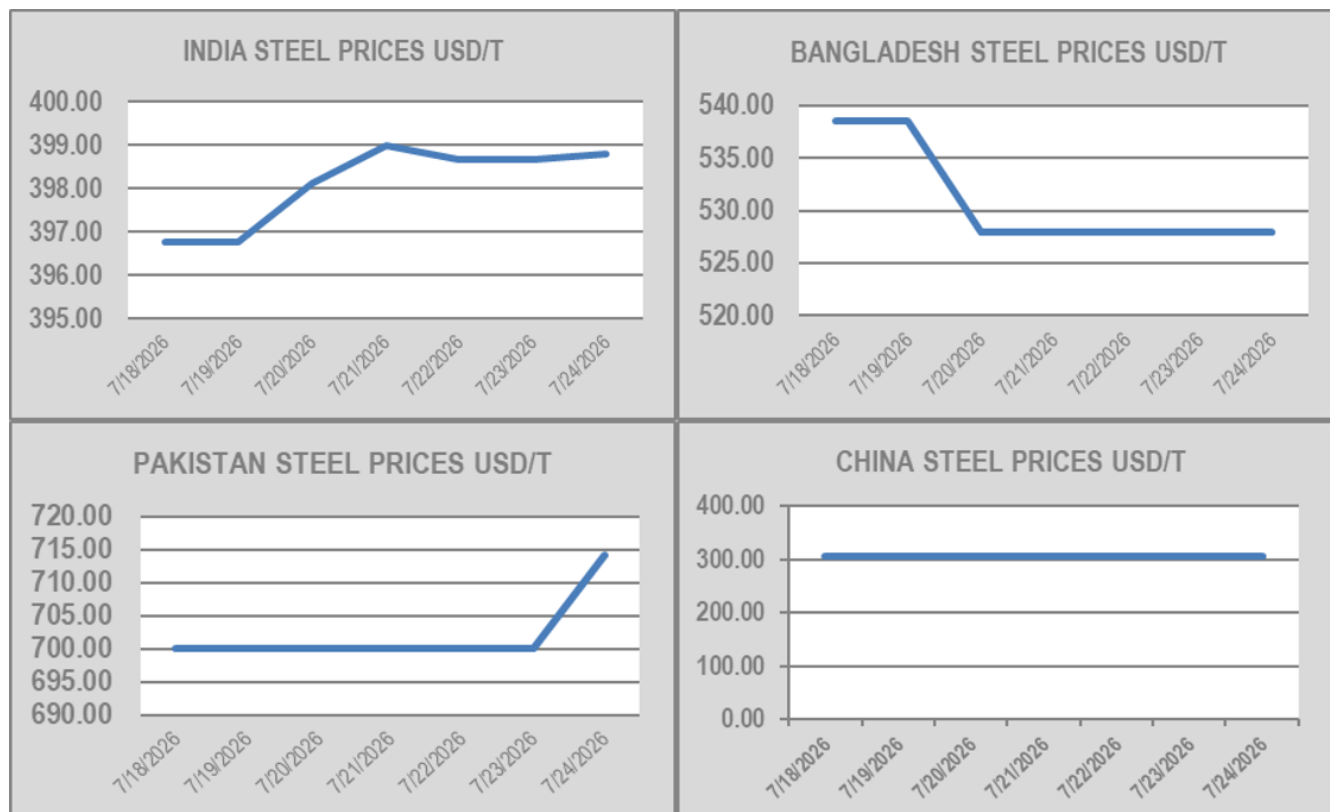
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Sunny	2,217	Container	Arrived July 23
2	Wantong 497	3,610	General Cargo	Arrived July 22
3	Bagus	2,385	General Cargo	Arrived July 18
4	Ever Delight	1,557	General Cargo	Arrived July 18
5	Isa Star	3,412	General Cargo	Delivered July 18
6	Tai Shuen	2,990	Tanker	Delivered July 16
7	Bulan	5,469	Bulk Carrier	Delivered July 14

GADANI - Port Position as of July 24, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
No new vessels reported.				

WHILE EXTREME CARE HAS BEEN TAKEN IN THE PREPARATION OF THIS REPORT, NO LIABILITY CAN BE ACCEPTED FOR ANY LOSS INCURRED IN ANY WAY WHATSOEVER BY ANY PERSON RELYING ON THE INFORMATION CONTAINED HEREIN.

DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
7/18/2026	396.76	38,200.00	700.00	196,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	306.32
7/19/2026	396.76	38,200.00	700.00	196,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	306.32
7/20/2026	398.13	38,400.00	700.00	196,000.00	527.95	64,700.00	306.32
7/21/2026	399.00	38,400.00	700.00	196,000.00	527.95	64,700.00	306.32
7/22/2026	398.67	38,500.00	700.00	196,000.00	527.95	64,700.00	306.32
7/23/2026	398.67	38,500.00	700.00	196,000.00	527.95	64,700.00	306.32
7/24/2026	398.80	38,500.00	714.29	200,000.00	527.95	64,700.00	306.32



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